How we test payments: every flow, every card, step by step

Our platform runs memberships for affiliates ($19.99/mo after 90 free days) and contractors ($99.90/mo after 30 free days). The free period always starts when our team approves the person, never at signup. While we test, the platform is connected to **test mode**: the card form is real, but no real money ever moves. Use the test cards below. Real cards are refused in test mode.

⚠️ **Emails and texts are real.** Sign-in codes, welcome emails and texts really go out. Test with **your own email and phone**. Every test person needs a **different email and a different phone number** (one role per person). With Gmail you can add `+aff1`, `+ctr1` … to your address, for example `you+ctr1@gmail.com`.

Test cards

For every card: use **any future expiry date** (e.g. `12/34`), **any 3-digit security code** (any 4 digits for Amex) and any ZIP.

Card number	Result	What it tests
4242 4242 4242 4242	Success	Visa that always works. Use it for the happy path and to recover from failures.
5555 5555 5555 4444	Success	Mastercard that always works. Use it to test **Replace card** (you'll see the brand and last 4 change).
4000 0025 0000 3155	Bank check	Opens a bank authentication window (3-D Secure). Click **Complete** to save the card, or **Fail** to see the error.
4000 0000 0000 0002	Declined	Generic decline. The card is not saved and the form shows the bank's message.
4000 0000 0000 9995	Declined	Insufficient funds.
4000 0000 0000 0069	Declined	Expired card.
4000 0000 0000 0127	Declined	Wrong security code (CVC).
4000 0000 0000 0341	Saves, then fails	Saves fine but **every charge fails**. Use it to test a failed payment, the portal pause and recovery (flow 5).

Tip: to see the "card expires soon" banner and the staff "Card expiring" badge, add 4242… with **this month** as the expiry date.

Who approves what (staff)

Affiliates

Admin → **Affiliates** → filter **Pending** → open the person → set status to **Active**. Their 90 free days start at that moment.

Contractors

Admin → **Contractors** → open the person → **Application** panel → mark license and insurance verified → **Approve** (you can approve with documents still missing if you add a note). The 30 free days start at that moment.

Super admins, admins and finance can manage memberships. Agents can view them. Everything is in Admin → **Billing**, or the **Manage membership** button on each record.

The flows to test

1 New affiliate: signup → setup link → approval

1. Open `/affiliate/signup` and apply. You'll see *"Check your email and texts"*.
2. Open the welcome email or text and tap the secure link (`/affiliate/welcome/…`).
3. Sign the agreement → submit the W-9 → add card **`4242 4242 4242 4242`**.
4. Staff approve the affiliate (see above).

Expect: before approval the card shows "Your 90 free days start when we approve you", and nothing is charged. After approval: status **Free period**, first charge in 90 days at $19.99, and Admin → Billing shows the affiliate.

2 New contractor: signup → application with card → approval

1. Open `/contractor/signup` and apply. Use the emailed link (`/contractor/apply/…`).
2. Fill in the application. On **Review & sign**, try **Submit** before adding a card: it stays disabled.
3. Try a decline card (**`…0002`**), then add **`4242 4242 4242 4242`**, sign and submit.
4. Staff approve the application. The contractor signs in at `/contractor/login`.

Expect: the decline card is refused with a clear message. After approval, the approval email says "30 days free, then $99.90/month starting [date]", the portal opens, and the dashboard shows the membership card.

3 Existing contractor without a card

1. Sign in as an already-active contractor who has never added a card.
2. Add **`4242…`** on the "Reactivate your contractor portal" screen.

Expect: every page shows the card screen until the card is saved, then the portal opens with a 30-day free period.

4 Replace card · cancel · resume (member side)

1. Contractor dashboard (or affiliate `/affiliate/agreement`) → **Replace card** → **`5555 5555 5555 4444`**.
2. **Cancel plan** → confirm, then **Keep my plan**.

Expect: the card changes to Mastercard •••• 4444 with no second free period. Cancel keeps access until the end of the paid month, and Keep my plan undoes it.

5 Failed payment → portal paused → recovery

1. Staff: Admin → Billing → open a test member → **Cancel** → *Cancel now* (any reason).
2. Staff: **Start with card link** → Free days **0** → Send. The member gets an email and text.
3. Member: open the link and add **`4000 0000 0000 0341`**. The charge fails right away.
4. Member: sign in, try **`…0341`** again, then add **`4242 4242 4242 4242`**.

Expect: after step 3 the contractor portal (or affiliate portal) is paused on the card screen, and the affiliate's payouts are held. A second bad card shows *"Your bank declined the new card"*. The good card pays the open invoice right away and the portal reopens. The affiliate referral link keeps working the whole time.

6 Staff tools: free days · price · refund

1. **Add free days** (+14) on a running plan. The member gets an email, and the next charge date moves.
2. **Price** → Custom $120 (or Waive). Custom applies from the next cycle; Waive cancels the plan and unlocks the portal.
3. **Refund:** start a member with a card link (Free days 0, card **`4242…`**) so there's a real charge. Then **Payments** → **Refund** $20, then refund the rest.

Expect: every action asks for a reason, appears in **Activity**, and emails the member. Receipts and PDFs open from Payments. You can't refund more than what's left.

7 Denied application

1. A contractor saves a card in the application and submits. Staff click **Deny**.

Expect: the saved card is removed and nothing is ever charged.

Sign-off checklist

- ☐ Affiliate: signup → link → card → approved → Free period
- ☐ Contractor: Submit blocked without a card
- ☐ Contractor: approved → Free period, portal open
- ☐ Decline cards refused (…0002, 9995, 0069, 0127)
- ☐ Bank-check card: Complete saves, Fail shows an error
- ☐ Replace card → brand and last 4 update
- ☐ Cancel / keep plan works
- ☐ …0341 → paused → 4242 → reopened
- ☐ Staff: free days, price, refund, activity log
- ☐ Phones: card form and screens look right (portrait and landscape)

🧹 **When testing is done**, we switch to Groundwork's own live payment account and clear the test billing data, so no test membership carries over. Until then, test data stays in test mode only.